

[AMIA LETTERHEAD]

[Date]

Unicode Consortium Emoji Subcommittee / Emoji Standard and Research Working Group Submitted via the Unicode emoji proposal process

Re: Support for standardized medical emoji in the Unicode Standard

Dear Members of the Unicode Emoji Subcommittee:

The American Medical Informatics Association (AMIA) writes to support the development and inclusion of a standardized set of medical emoji in the Unicode Standard. AMIA is the professional home for more than [5,500] biomedical and health informatics professionals — physicians, nurses, researchers, data scientists, and informaticians — who advance the use of information and technology to improve health. Standardized vocabularies, interoperability, and clear communication between clinicians and patients are central to our mission.

Communication in medicine must be clear, accessible, and adaptable across languages, literacy levels, ages, and disabilities. Emoji have become one of the most widely used visual languages in the world, and they are increasingly appearing in patient messages, portal communication, and the clinical record itself — yet the vocabulary available for health and the human body remains limited. Standardized medical emoji are, in informatics terms, a form of controlled clinical iconography: simple, universally rendered visual anchors for common clinical concepts. They would not replace clinical language or professional interpretation. They would add a familiar, globally available, and interoperable communication layer for patient education, discharge instructions, public-health messaging, medical education, and everyday communication between patients and clinicians.

AMIA recognizes that Unicode evaluates each proposal through a formal standards process, and that every candidate must meet Unicode's criteria for distinctiveness, expected usage, image licensing, and broad applicability. Our support is professional and informatics-grounded: the concepts advanced by the Medical Emoji Project are relevant across specialties and care settings, and they speak directly to interoperability, health literacy, and patient-centered communication in modern digital environments. The earlier addition of the anatomical heart and lungs to the Unicode Standard demonstrated both the feasibility and the value of accurate medical symbols, which now serve clinicians, educators, and patients worldwide.

AMIA therefore supports the continued development and submission of medical emoji proposals, including the **kidney, liver, stomach, spine, white blood cell, and electrocardiogram (EKG)**, as well as the broader effort to build a more complete set of clinically meaningful symbols. We encourage Unicode reviewers and platform vendors to give full consideration to the clinical, educational, accessibility, and public-health value of these symbols. We further welcome the

opportunity for the informatics community to serve as an ongoing resource to Unicode in ensuring that future medical symbols are accurate, distinct, interoperable, and useful.

Sincerely,

[Signatory Name], MD, [credentials] \ [President / Board Chair / Chief Executive Officer], American Medical Informatics Association